

Telegram Mini App

Feature 3 of 13 — your full tool catalog, opening inside Telegram itself.

No app store

No extra hosting

Matches user's theme automatically

1 What this does

A Mini App is a normal web page that opens *inside* Telegram's own interface — no browser tab, no app install. Your catalog now has a version at `/telegram` built specifically for this: it detects Telegram's theme (light/dark/custom) and repaints itself to match, shows a personalized "Hey, [name]" greeting, and every tool tap opens correctly through Telegram's own link handler.

It uses no different data — same `data/products.json` catalog as the website and the daily bot post.

2 Deploy first

Telegram requires HTTPS

Mini Apps only work over a real public HTTPS URL — Telegram will not load `localhost`. Deploy the site (see the main README's "Put it online for free" section) before doing the steps below. You'll need your live URL, e.g.

`https://yourdomain.com`.

3 Register it with BotFather

Uses the same bot you already created for the daily poster (feature 1). Two ways to attach a Mini App to it — pick one:

OPTION A — SIMPLEST

Menu Button

Message `@BotFather` → `/mybots`
→ select your bot → **Bot Settings** →

Menu Button → **Configure Menu Button** → paste

`https://yourdomain.com/telegram`
and a label like "Open App".

OPTION B — SHAREABLE

/newapp

Message `@BotFather` →
`/newapp` → follow the prompts
(short name, title, description,
icon, then the same `/telegram`
URL). This gives you a
shareable link like
`t.me/yourbot/appname`.

EITHER WAY

Test it

Open a chat with your own bot in Telegram (mobile app works best) and tap the menu button / app link. Your catalog should open inside Telegram, themed to match your Telegram app.

4 How the theming works (for reference, no setup needed)

Telegram passes theme colors and user info to the page automatically once it loads — no configuration required. The relevant code:

<code>app/telegram/page.tsx</code>	The Mini App route
<code>components/TelegramMiniApp.tsx</code>	The catalog UI shown inside Telegram
<code>components/TelegramWebApp.tsx</code>	Loads Telegram's SDK, reads theme colors and user info
<code>components/SiteChrome.tsx</code>	Hides the normal website nav/footer on this one route

Previewing without Telegram

Visiting `yourdomain.com/telegram` in a normal desktop browser still works — it just falls back to light/dark based on your system theme, with no personalized greeting, since there's no real Telegram client to read data from.

5 Customizing it

- **Change what's shown:** edit `components/TelegramMiniApp.tsx` — it's a normal React component.
- **Change the icon/name Telegram shows:** re-run `/newapp`'s settings via BotFather → `/myapps`.
- **Add a native-feeling action button:** Telegram's SDK has a `MainButton` API (not wired up yet) — ask to have it added if you want e.g. a persistent "Suggest a Tool" button.

6 Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
Menu button does nothing	Double-check the URL you gave BotFather is your real deployed HTTPS domain, not localhost
Opens but looks like a plain website (nav/footer visible)	Make sure you're opening <code>/telegram</code> , not the homepage <code>/</code>
Colors look wrong	Telegram itself controls these via the user's chosen theme — try switching your own Telegram app's theme to see it update
Tapping a tool does nothing	Update to the latest Telegram app version — older clients may not support <code>openLink</code>